Nexora Technologies Ltd.

Meal and Hotel Spending Limits

Daily limits for accommodation and meals by grade and city

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Classification	Internal - for employees only

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1. Introduction

This document sets the daily spending limits for hotels and meals during business travel at Nexora Technologies Ltd. It is a companion to the Travel and Expense Reimbursement Policy (NX-FIN-POL-012). The limits are tied to the employee's grade and to the tier of the city visited, because the cost of a reasonable hotel room or a sensible meal in Mumbai is very different from the cost in Madurai.

The limits are caps and not entitlements. An employee is reimbursed the actual cost up to the cap, and any spend above the cap is borne by the employee unless an exception is approved under the Approval Rules and Exceptions document (NX-FIN-POL-014). Limits include all taxes and service charges unless stated otherwise.

Limits are reviewed every year in March by the Finance Controller with input from HR and the travel desk, using hotel rate data from the previous 12 months. The version in force on the day an expense is incurred applies to that expense.

2. City Tier Classification

Every destination is placed in one of four tiers. Tier 1 covers the largest and most expensive business cities. Tier 2 covers other large cities. Tier 3 covers all other Indian cities and towns, including any city not named below. International destinations form their own tier.

Tier	Cities	Remarks
Tier 1	Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chennai, Pune, Kolkata, Gurugram	Highest hotel and meal costs
Tier 2	Ahmedabad, Jaipur, Kochi, Coimbatore, Indore, Lucknow, Chandigarh, Nagpur, Bhubaneswar, Visakhapatnam	Mid-range costs
Tier 3	Mysuru, Vijayawada, Madurai, Raipur, Guwahati, Udaipur, Dehradun and all other Indian locations	Lower costs
International	Singapore, Dubai, London and other overseas locations	Limits fixed in INR per day

When a trip includes several cities, each night and each day is assessed against the city where the employee stays or works that day. When a city is within 40 kilometres of a Tier 1 city and the hotel is chosen for proximity to the customer site, the Tier 1 limit applies. The Finance Controller may reclassify a city during the year if hotel rates change materially, and will publish the change on the intranet 30 days before it takes effect.

3. Hotel Limits by Grade

The hotel limit is the maximum room rate per night, inclusive of GST and service charges, for a single occupancy room. Breakfast included in the room rate is covered within the hotel limit and breakfast must then not be claimed separately under meals.

Grade	Title	Tier 1 (INR/night)	Tier 2 (INR/night)	Tier 3 (INR/night)
L1	Associate	4,500	3,500	2,500

Grade	Title	Tier 1 (INR/night)	Tier 2 (INR/night)	Tier 3 (INR/night)
L2	Senior Associate	4,500	3,500	2,500
L3	Manager	7,000	5,500	4,000
L4	Senior Manager	7,000	5,500	4,000
L5	Director	10,000	8,000	6,000
L6	Vice President	14,000	11,000	8,000

The grade used is the grade of the traveller. Where several employees travel together, each stays within the limit for his or her own grade. A senior employee must not book a more expensive hotel and ask juniors to share the cost.

4. Hotel Booking Rules

4.1 Preferred hotels and channels

The travel desk maintains a list of preferred hotels in each major city with negotiated rates that are almost always below the cap. Employees should choose from this list. A hotel outside the list is allowed when the rate is within the cap and the property is a recognised business hotel; where proximity to a client site is the reason, exception EX-08 may be used.

4.2 Rules

- Single occupancy only. Employees of the same gender and grade band travelling together are encouraged to share a twin room, and the cap for the room is then the sum of both limits.
- Only business nights are reimbursed. The night before an early meeting and the night after a late meeting qualify if travel on the same day is not practical.
- Hotel invoices must carry the Company's GSTIN. Hotels outside the preferred list must provide a tax invoice, not a booking confirmation.
- Room upgrades, suites, club lounges, spa and minibar are not reimbursed.
- Cancellations should be made at least 24 hours in advance. No-show and late-cancellation charges are reimbursed only when the reason was beyond the employee's control.
- Loyalty points earned on Company-paid stays belong to the employee, but must not influence the choice of hotel.
- If the hotel includes breakfast, the employee may not claim a separate breakfast.
- Where no hotel within the cap is available, the employee may book the nearest alternative and raise exception EX-02, attaching a screenshot showing the unavailable inventory.

5. Meal Limits by Grade

The meal limit is the maximum amount reimbursable for all meals on one calendar day while the employee is travelling, inclusive of taxes and service charges. It covers breakfast, lunch, dinner and non-alcoholic beverages and snacks.

Grade	Title	Tier 1 (INR/day)	Tier 2 (INR/day)	Tier 3 (INR/day)
L1	Associate	1,200	1,000	800

Grade	Title	Tier 1 (INR/day)	Tier 2 (INR/day)	Tier 3 (INR/day)
L2	Senior Associate	1,200	1,000	800
L3	Manager	1,800	1,500	1,200
L4	Senior Manager	1,800	1,500	1,200
L5	Director	2,500	2,000	1,600
L6	Vice President	3,200	2,600	2,000

5.1 Suggested split of the daily limit

Meal	Share of daily limit	Example for L3 in Tier 1 (INR 1,800)
Breakfast	20 percent	360
Lunch	35 percent	630
Dinner	45 percent	810

The split is a guide only. An employee may spend more on dinner and less on breakfast as long as the total for the day stays within the daily limit.

6. Meal Rules

- The daily limit applies to every calendar day of the trip, including the day of departure and the day of return.
- Meals provided by the customer, the conference or the hotel package must not be claimed. If a meal is provided for part of a day, the daily limit is reduced by the share of that meal.
- Alcohol, tobacco and similar items are never reimbursed, even if they are part of a combined bill. Finance deducts them.
- Where a team eats together, the senior employee pays and claims, listing the names of all attendees. The per-person cost is tested against the daily limit of each attendee's grade.
- Client entertainment is not a personal meal. It is claimed as Client Entertainment, with a limit of INR 2,500 per head, and does not use up the daily meal limit.
- Meals for a day of one-way travel starting after 2 pm or ending before 11 am are limited to dinner or lunch respectively.
- Receipts are needed for each meal above INR 300. Up to INR 300 per day can be declared without a receipt, subject to INR 1,000 per month.
- Exceeding the limit because of customer hosting can be approved under exception EX-03, with the guest list attached.

7. Limits by Grade - Plain Language Summary

7.1 L1 - Associate

An employee in grade L1 may spend up to INR 4,500 per night on a hotel in a Tier 1 city, INR 3,500 in Tier 2 and INR 2,500 in Tier 3. Daily meals are capped at INR 1,200, INR 1,000 and INR 800 respectively. International stays are capped at INR 12,000 per night and INR 4,500 per day.

7.2 L2 - Senior Associate

An employee in grade L2 may spend up to INR 4,500 per night on a hotel in a Tier 1 city, INR 3,500 in Tier 2 and INR 2,500 in Tier 3. Daily meals are capped at INR 1,200, INR 1,000 and INR 800 respectively. International stays are capped at INR 12,000 per night and INR 4,500 per day.

7.3 L3 - Manager

An employee in grade L3 may spend up to INR 7,000 per night on a hotel in a Tier 1 city, INR 5,500 in Tier 2 and INR 4,000 in Tier 3. Daily meals are capped at INR 1,800, INR 1,500 and INR 1,200 respectively. International stays are capped at INR 16,000 per night and INR 6,000 per day.

7.4 L4 - Senior Manager

An employee in grade L4 may spend up to INR 7,000 per night on a hotel in a Tier 1 city, INR 5,500 in Tier 2 and INR 4,000 in Tier 3. Daily meals are capped at INR 1,800, INR 1,500 and INR 1,200 respectively. International stays are capped at INR 16,000 per night and INR 6,000 per day.

7.5 L5 - Director

An employee in grade L5 may spend up to INR 10,000 per night on a hotel in a Tier 1 city, INR 8,000 in Tier 2 and INR 6,000 in Tier 3. Daily meals are capped at INR 2,500, INR 2,000 and INR 1,600 respectively. International stays are capped at INR 22,000 per night and INR 8,000 per day.

7.6 L6 - Vice President

An employee in grade L6 may spend up to INR 14,000 per night on a hotel in a Tier 1 city, INR 11,000 in Tier 2 and INR 8,000 in Tier 3. Daily meals are capped at INR 3,200, INR 2,600 and INR 2,000 respectively. International stays are capped at INR 30,000 per night and INR 10,000 per day.

8. International Limits

Grade	Hotel (INR/night)	Meals (INR/day)	Air class
L1	12,000	4,500	Economy
L2	12,000	4,500	Economy
L3	16,000	6,000	Economy
L4	16,000	6,000	Economy
L5	22,000	8,000	Premium economy over 6 hours
L6	30,000	10,000	Business over 6 hours

International limits are fixed in INR and are not converted each day, so that employees know their cap before they leave. The limits apply across all overseas cities. In unusually expensive cities, such as London during major events, the Finance Controller may approve a temporary higher limit through exception EX-01. International travel must be booked at least 14 days in advance, otherwise exception EX-11 is needed.

9. Peak Season and Event Surge Rules

Hotel rates rise sharply during festivals, large events and holiday weeks. To prevent employees being forced to choose between the cap and the trip, the Company allows an uplift to the hotel cap during the periods below, in the cities concerned. The uplift is not automatic; the employee must select exception EX-01 and cite the event.

Event or period	Typical window	Cities	Maximum uplift on hotel cap
Dussehra and Diwali week	Late Sept to early Nov	All Tier 1 and Tier 2	25 percent
New Year week	24 Dec to 2 Jan	Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru, Hyderabad	30 percent
IPL match weekend	Match days and the day before	Match venue city	20 percent
Large trade fairs and exhibitions	As per event dates	Venue city	25 percent
Wedding season peak	Nov to Feb weekends	Jaipur, Udaipur, Kochi	20 percent
Tourist peak	May and June	Dehradun, Udaipur, Mysuru	15 percent

For example, an L3 employee in Hyderabad during New Year week has a standard cap of INR 7,000, and with a 30 percent uplift may spend up to INR 9,100 per night. The Finance Controller may refuse the uplift if cheaper hotels were available at the time of booking.

10. Extended Stays

A stay of up to 14 consecutive nights at one location is covered by the standard limits. For longer stays the employee should consider a serviced apartment or a monthly rate. Stays between 15 and 45 nights need exception EX-12, for which the hotel cap is reduced by 15 percent from the 15th night, since monthly rates are cheaper. Meal limits for extended stays are reduced by 20 percent from the 15th day, and the employee is encouraged to use kitchen facilities.

Assignments longer than 45 nights are treated as temporary relocation and are governed by the HR Mobility Policy, not by this document.

11. Worked Examples

11.1 L2 employee, Hyderabad to Mumbai, 2 nights

Hotel cap is INR 4,500 x 2 = INR 9,000. The employee spends INR 8,400, which is within the cap and is reimbursed in full. Meal cap for 3 days is INR 3,600; spend of INR 3,100 is reimbursed in full.

11.2 L3 employee, Bengaluru to Jaipur, 3 nights

Jaipur is Tier 2. The hotel cap is INR 5,500 x 3 = INR 16,500. The employee books at INR 6,200 per night, which is INR 18,600 in total. The excess of INR 2,100 is not reimbursed unless exception EX-01 or EX-02 applies.

11.3 L4 employee, Delhi, client dinner

The employee spends INR 4,800 on dinner with 3 guests, so 4 people. The Client Entertainment cap is INR 2,500 x 4 = INR 10,000, so the full amount is reimbursed under Client Entertainment, not under meals.

11.4 L1 employee, Mysuru, 1 night

Mysuru is Tier 3. The hotel cap is INR 2,500. The employee books at INR 2,350 and has meals of INR 1,900 over 2 days against a cap of INR 1,600. Both are reimbursed in full.

11.5 L5 employee, Chennai during a trade fair

The standard Tier 1 cap is INR 10,000. With a 25 percent trade fair uplift the cap becomes INR 12,500. The employee books at INR 12,000 and cites EX-01, which is approved.

11.6 L6 employee, Singapore, 4 nights

The international hotel cap is INR 30,000 x 4 = INR 120,000. The meal cap is INR 10,000 x 5 days = INR 50,000. Business class is allowed on flights over 6 hours.

11.7 L3 employee, 20-night project in Pune

The first 14 nights use the standard cap of INR 7,000. For nights 15 to 20 the cap is reduced by 15 percent to INR 5,950. The trip needs EX-12.

11.8 L2 employee, meals with a customer-paid lunch

The daily cap is reduced by the lunch share of 35 percent. For a Tier 2 day the cap of INR 1,000 becomes INR 650 for the remaining meals.

12. Handling Breaches

When a claim contains an hotel or meal amount above the limit, the Expense Portal marks the line as "Exceeds limit". The employee then has three options: accept the reduction, correct the item if there is an error, or request an exception with a written justification. The reporting manager cannot waive the limit alone.

Breach	Normal handling	Typical exception
Hotel above cap by up to 10 percent	Excess deducted; no exception needed if the reason is documented	EX-01 or EX-02
Hotel above cap by more than 10 percent	Exception mandatory, with screenshot of alternatives	EX-01, EX-02, EX-08
Meals above daily limit	Excess deducted unless hosting a customer	EX-03
Repeated breaches (3 in a quarter)	Manager conversation and review by Finance	None
Receipt missing	Return the claim or use lost-receipt declaration	EX-05

Employees who exceed limits in more than 20 percent of their claims over a half-year period are reviewed by their manager and the Finance Controller. Where a pattern suggests deliberate overspending, the matter is referred to HR.

13. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Is the hotel cap per night or per trip?
A: Per night, per person, including taxes.

Q: Does the cap include GST?
A: Yes. The limits are inclusive of all taxes and service charges.

Q: Can I average my meal spending across days?
A: Yes, over the days of one trip, as long as no single day exceeds twice the daily limit and the total stays within the sum of daily limits.

Q: Can I use a higher limit because my customer is senior?
A: No. Use the Client Entertainment category, or request EX-03.

Q: What if I stay in a Tier 1 city for a Tier 2 meeting?
A: The limit is based on the city where you stay and work that day.

Q: Do the limits change when my grade changes during a trip?
A: The grade at the start of the trip applies for the whole trip.

Q: Can two employees pool their limits?
A: Pooling is allowed only for a shared twin room.

Q: Is breakfast at a hotel buffet claimable separately?
A: Not if breakfast is included in the room rate.

Q: What happens if I book a cheaper hotel?
A: You are reimbursed the actual amount. The cap is not a payment.

Q: Are tips reimbursed?
A: Tips up to 10 percent of a restaurant bill are included in the meal limit.

14. Special Situations

14.1 Safety and accessibility

An employee may choose a hotel above the cap for safety reasons, for example when travelling alone late at night or when the cheaper hotels near the meeting are in locations the travel desk has flagged as unsafe. The employee should note the reason in the claim and select exception EX-02 or EX-09 where relevant. Employees with accessibility needs, or those travelling with medical equipment, may be reimbursed for a suitable room above the cap with the approval of HR and the Finance Controller.

14.2 Conferences and group events

When a conference negotiates a block rate at a host hotel, the block rate is accepted even if it exceeds the cap by up to 15 percent, provided the registration confirmation shows the block rate. The employee should attach the conference confirmation to the claim. Employees must not claim a hotel when the conference fee already includes accommodation.

14.3 Travel during illness or disruption

If a flight is cancelled or a storm or strike delays the return, the extra hotel nights are reimbursed at actuals up to the cap plus 20 percent. The employee must attach the airline notice or a screenshot of the disruption. Extra meal costs on such days are reimbursed up to the standard daily limit.

14.4 Personal extension of a trip

If an employee extends a business trip for personal reasons, hotel and meals are reimbursed only for the business nights and days. The employee must identify the personal nights in the claim. The hotel invoice must be split, and any difference in the airfare caused by the extension is borne by the employee.

15. Indicative Hotel Rate Benchmarks

The table below lists indicative average business-hotel rates for 3-star and 4-star properties, taken from the travel desk's bookings over the last 12 months. It is provided to help employees understand what the limits can buy. It is not a limit. The cap always comes from the grade table.

City	Tier	4-star average (INR/night)	3-star average (INR/night)
Mumbai	1	7,800	5,400
Delhi	1	7,200	5,100
Bengaluru	1	6,900	4,800
Hyderabad	1	6,300	4,400
Chennai	1	6,000	4,200
Pune	1	5,700	4,000
Kolkata	1	5,500	3,800
Gurugram	1	7,000	4,900
Ahmedabad	2	4,600	3,300
Jaipur	2	5,100	3,500
Kochi	2	4,800	3,400
Coimbatore	2	4,100	3,000
Indore	2	3,900	2,800
Lucknow	2	4,000	2,900
Mysuru	3	3,300	2,300
Vijayawada	3	3,100	2,200
Guwahati	3	3,500	2,400
Singapore	Intl	17,500	12,500
Dubai	Intl	15,500	11,000
London	Intl	24,000	17,500

An L2 employee in Mumbai has a cap of INR 4,500, which is below the typical 3-star rate of INR 5,400. Such employees are advised to book early, use the preferred list and consider properties outside the busiest districts, or to request exception EX-02 when no compliant hotel is available. The

Finance Controller reviews these benchmarks every March when setting the new limits.

16. Monitoring and Review

Finance publishes a monthly dashboard showing the average hotel rate and the average meal spend per grade and tier, the percentage of items above limit, and the number of exceptions by code. The dashboard is shared with department heads. A department whose items exceed limits more than 15 percent of the time must present an action plan to the CFO.

The limits in this document are reviewed every March. Proposals for change can be sent by any employee to the Finance Controller, and are considered against hotel price indices, inflation and the results of the monthly dashboard.

17. Appendix - Quick Reference Card

Grade	Hotel T1	Hotel T2	Hotel T3	Meals T1	Meals T2	Meals T3
L1	4,500	3,500	2,500	1,200	1,000	800
L2	4,500	3,500	2,500	1,200	1,000	800
L3	7,000	5,500	4,000	1,800	1,500	1,200
L4	7,000	5,500	4,000	1,800	1,500	1,200
L5	10,000	8,000	6,000	2,500	2,000	1,600
L6	14,000	11,000	8,000	3,200	2,600	2,000

Revision history: Version 4.2, effective 1 April 2026 - hotel and meal limits revised upward by about 8 percent; peak season table added. Version 4.1, 1 April 2025 - international limits added. Version 4.0, 1 April 2024 - city tiers introduced.